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Chapter 38: Postface—Semimodernity and Rooted Globalism

> The term modernity has been naively defined by our present-day social scientists in terms of machines and organizational efficiency for economic and political purposes. Even where they speak of the quality of human life they still measure modernity by such things as mobility or consumption patterns. We have to realize that that is no more than *semimodernity* at best. Freedom from want does not lead to freedom from interpersonal anxiety and hostility. Unless man can dispense with the magical mode of thinking in human affairs as well, he is not modern. In fact, unless he achieves the latter freedom, much or most of what he has accomplished or will accomplish in the former sphere will be in vain, for he will only go through cycles of destruction, reconstruction, and bigger destruction, and more colossal reconstruction.
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> — Francis L. K. Hsu, *Americans and Chinese: Passage to Differences*, 3rd ed., 1981

This passage appears in the preface to the 1981 third edition of *Americans and Chinese*. Forty-five years later, it does not need a single word amended.

This book has traced a process: discretization as a meta-operation through which continuous human experience is discretized into units that can be operated upon by capital—from indulgences to algorithms, from mortgage loans to collateralized debt obligation squared (CDO^2), from city streets to social media information flows, from human judgment (when the task of judgment is delegated to model outputs) to artificial intelligence (AI) token sequences. Each wave of discretization has released enormous potential energy—technological innova-

tion, economic growth, efficiency gains. Each wave of discretization has also accumulated cognitive debt—the fragmentation of individual attention, the degradation of judgment, the hollowing out of relational networks, group polarization, the erosion of the foundations of legitimacy.

This is the "semimodernity" named by Hsu. This book uses the term to identify an imbalance: industrial systems and global connectivity have kept expanding, greatly increasing the capacity to alleviate material scarcity; modernization at the interpersonal level has never begun—humans still rely, when dealing with their relationships with one another, on what Hsu called "the magical mode of thinking": taking the atomized individual as the ontological default for the person, substituting role relations for affective relations, compensating for the absence of intimate bonds with non-human objects.

Algorithmic *Xiangyuan* (village worthies) is the latest form of this magical thinking in the technological age—not predicting the future through divination, but simulating understanding through statistical correlation. Not appeasing the gods through sacrifice, but appeasing users through Reinforcement Learning from Human Feedback (RLHF) alignment—a tendency reinforced when preference feedback rewards agreement rather than correction. The form has changed. The structure has not. The cycle diagnosed by Hsu in 1981—"destruction, reconstruction, and bigger destruction, and more colossal reconstruction"—manifests in the financial domain as the succession of the 1929 Great Depression, the 1998 Long-Term Capital Management (LTCM) crisis, and the 2008 financial crisis (Chapter 22), in the AI domain as a risk of recursion from model collapse to bigger models to deeper collapse when model outputs continue to feed back into training data without independent calibration (Chapter 13, §3.2), and in urban space as a risk pathway from the disintegration of physical communities to the false substitution of digital communities to deeper isolation (Chapter 33).

Within this cyclical pattern diagnosed by Hsu, each "more colossal reconstruction" has been more magnificent at the material level—larger models, faster algorithms, higher market capitalizations—while each reconstruction has also been more hollow at the interpersonal level—more connections but less intimacy, more information but less understanding, more expression but less listening.

Von Neumann, in 1955, arrived at the same judgment from the endpoint of physics. His formulation was more engineering-oriented than Hsu's but pointed in the same direction: technological progress has an intrinsic global and infinitely expansive impulse, while the container that bears the consequences has a natural locality and slowness. When the radius of technology reaches the size of the Earth itself, "further acceleration can no longer be absorbed as in the past by an extension of the area of operations" (von Neumann, 1955).

His prescription was patience, flexibility, intelligence—words this book reads as belonging to the time dimension. What he said was the sustained exercise of daily judgment—a series of small, correct, day-to-day decisions.

Hsu, from the endpoint of anthropology, arrived at the other half of the same diagnosis. What von Neumann said was "what needs to be done" (sustained work). What Hsu said was "why it cannot be done" (semimodernity—the achievements at the material level have obscured the failures at the interpersonal level). Taken together, the two constitute a complete diagnosis: sustained work is needed (von Neumann), but civilization's magical mode of thinking at the interpersonal level systematically prevents humans from doing the work (Hsu).

Joseph Weizenbaum, in 1976, gave a third form of the same diagnosis from the interior of computer science. His book—*Computer Power and Human Reason*—placed its core thesis in the subtitle: *From Judgment to Calculation*. The true danger of the modern computer is not that it replaces certain human capacities, but that

it degrades "judgment" into "calculation" (Weizenbaum, 1976): compressing decisions that require context, responsibility, and commitment into rule-governed processing of data. This book spells out the distinction as follows: Judgment must select, within a concrete situation not exhaustively covered by rules, a decision for which an identifiable agent accepts responsibility; calculation merely executes, within a given set of rules, a computation whose conformity to those rules can be checked. The outputs of the two may look identical on specific occasions, but the difference between responsibility being assumed and not being assumed is structural.

Weizenbaum made clear the mechanism by which the habit Hsu diagnosed—compressing concrete relationships into type-based treatment—operates at the technological endpoint: it is not that capacity is replaced by the machine; it is that the task of judgment itself is surreptitiously swapped for a lower-dimensional task—performing a computation within a given rule set, no longer selecting, within a situation not exhaustively covered by rules, a decision for which an identifiable agent accepts responsibility. After the task has been swapped, computation continues while responsibility for the decision goes unclaimed.

This swap was already diagnosed at an earlier philosophical level. Hume, in 1739–1740, in the final paragraph of Book III, Part I, Section I of *A Treatise of Human Nature*, made an observation later known as the is-ought problem: in every system of morality he had encountered, authors begin by reasoning in terms of is (statements of fact), and then at some point imperceptibly slip into ought (statements of value)—and authors did not commonly explain this new relation or justify the inference (Hume, 1739–1740/1888, Book III, Part I, Section I). Statements of fact and statements of value belong to two different categories; no automatic logical inference exists between them; ought cannot be "computed" from is.[1]

Degrading judgment into calculation is precisely the engineered form of this slip at the technological endpoint—accounting tools undertake a task whose impossibility Hume long ago pointed out: by measuring is (how many tonnes of carbon, how many dollars of gross domestic product (GDP), how many watts of power, how many tokens), they automatically produce an ought (whether this combustion should occur, whether this deployment is good). It cannot succeed on the AI infrastructure of 2026, not because the measurements are insufficiently precise, but because the category of the inference itself does not permit it.

The same requirement applies to arguments on both sides—not inferring "AI should be advanced" from "AI is useful," nor inferring "AI should be restricted" from "AI is harmful." Both types of discourse commit the same categorical error. Chapter 32, §5 has already performed the same analysis from the engineering side: all deployments beyond that boundary jointly marked by Weizenbaum and Dijkstra—the Chapter 32 formulation "keeping the computer in the position where it can stand"—are today being quietly advanced through accounting that cannot, by itself, justify accepting their costs. That account cannot be settled not because it has not yet been kept, nor because the consequences cannot be recorded or measured, but because the column that needs to be settled—which costs should be accepted—was never in the factual layer to begin with. The unquantifiable is not thereby unrecordable, and what has been quantified is not thereby justified.

But stopping at the epistemological level of is/ought is not enough. To read the accounting category error only as "facts cannot yield values" leaves the argument at the boundary of instrumental reason—it points out

[1] In the contemporary Chinese-language philosophical context, Wang Defeng, in his *Studies on Marx's Historical Ontology*, discussed Hume's problem of deriving value judgments from factual judgments—what is the case does not by itself establish what ought to be (Wang Defeng, *Studies on Marx's Historical Ontology*, lecture recording, https://www.bilibili.com/video/BV1Dx8gzgESd/). This section fulfills the promise of Chapter 1, footnote 6, that the second Humean problem would be reserved for the chapter on "the conditions of existence for the human being as human."

that instrumental reason cannot crown itself as purposive reason, but it has not yet examined a value premise that treats output as sufficient justification: if AI deployment "yields genuine productive benefits," does that legitimize this acceleration of the Earth's burning? Distinguishing spurious from genuine productive gains does not address a further premise of the output-centered accounting criticized here: that sufficient genuine output can compensate for damage to the conditions of human existence as human. This chapter rejects that compensatory premise. Chapter 32, §5 explicitly left in abeyance whether this burning purchases a pressing human need that cannot readily be met otherwise, noting that accounting indicators cannot answer it; this chapter's answer is that the ledger can never be balanced—these conditions are not another ledger entry to be offset by output; they are what makes output meaningful at all.

Yet the judgment this book seeks to establish does not lie at the level of "the real or pseudo nature of productivity." The entire table of productivity accounting has already asked the wrong question—burning the Earth, accumulating cognitive debt, degrading judgment into calculation, regardless of whether the output thus obtained is ultimately classified as "genuine" or "pseudo," the problem does not lie in that column but one step earlier: the accounting premise of this entire table is the reduction of "the conditions of existence for the human being as human" to "output."

And what this chapter seeks to safeguard is not "the existence of the Earth"—the Earth has existed for 4.54 billion years; by current astronomical-geological time scales, regardless of what humanity does during this episode of combustion, the Earth will persist in some state for billions of years. What needs to be safeguarded are **the conditions of existence for the human being as human**, at three nested scales:

- At the individual scale, it is the existence of the person as a judging subject—that boundary jointly marked by Weizenbaum and Dijkstra above, safeguarding judgment from being absorbed into calculation;
- At the relational scale, it is the existence of affective chains between persons—the core region in Hsu's sense from Chapter 5, that field of affective calibration that can still be maintained under the dual pressure of algorithmic *Xiangyuan* and the automation paradox;
- At the dwelling scale, it is that **stable Holocene window** within which the human being can dwell as human on the Earth—according to the *Planetary Health Check* released by the Planetary Boundaries Science project in 2025, seven of the nine planetary boundaries have already been breached, with ocean acidification formally assessed as having crossed the boundary for the first time in 2025; the 2023 assessment had found six boundaries breached (PBScience, 2025; Richardson et al., 2023). The scientific evidence cited in the same report indicates: if too many irreversible tipping points can be avoided, Earth will likely remain in a Holocene-like state for another approximately 50,000 years before naturally moving toward the next ice age, and it is precisely this window that enabled agriculture and modern civilization to develop (PBScience, 2025: §2.1). This window is a period, on the order of tens of thousands of years on the Earth's own time scale, during which the Earth is open to humans in a specific state; its closing does not mean the disappearance of the Earth, but damage to the stable conditions of dwelling that enabled agriculture and modern civilization to develop.

These three layers are not three parallel objects; they are mutually dependent but not mutually substitutable: gains at one level cannot automatically offset losses at another. To write them all as "output" is only because the kind of accounting this book criticizes recognizes only the column of output; what cannot be entered into the table is not nonexistent, but the cells of the table itself were designed to forbid their appearance. The accounting work of the Macro-Cognitive Accounting Framework (MCAF) throughout this book has been to render visible

those conditions of existence that have been reduced to output, not to add an additional column in the accounting table contrasting "pseudo-productivity" with "genuine productivity."

The real proposition is not "whether what AI yields is genuine productivity." The real proposition is: under conditions where computing power has been centrally allocated and data and attention have been industrially extracted, whether the threefold conditions of existence above can still be safeguarded. To safeguard them is not to make productivity higher, more real, or more sustainable; it is because, without them, the very user to whom the word "productivity" points would themselves disappear. Chapter 5, §3.1 already set a boundary within the book for this analysis—Lou Yulie's statement that "humanism degenerated into anthropocentrism. People did not expect that in wanting to determine everything, humanity would end up being determined by everything" (author's translation). This chapter applies the same distinction to accounting: reducing the conditions of existence to output is precisely the contemporary echo, at the engineering layer, of that cultural premise of "wanting to determine everything."

Laozi, from a still more ancient position, gave the ontological formulation of the same judgment: "Therefore this is how what is there provides benefit and how what is not there provides functionality" (*Tao Te Ching*, ch. 11; Lynn, 1999). All material achievements ("being") are merely "benefit" (li). This book further reads the conditions that sustain the existence of the human being as human as "non-being"—friction, pause, silence, the space of non-response—and those are the true "function" (yong). A precise description of semimodernity: humanity has achieved unprecedented accomplishments in the dimension of "being" while systematically losing ground in the dimension of "non-being."

The framework proposed by this book—MCAF—is an accounting tool. It does not predict when a crisis will occur. It does not judge whose civilization is better. It does one simple thing: requiring the record to include both ends of every cognitive transaction. What the projection side projected, what burdens the defense side bore, where the residual sediments. Within these mandated records, omission triggers an alert.

But accounting is not the end. The end is to enable each civilization to see that column in its own ledger that has been systematically obscured.

Chapter 5 (Hsu) argued: traditional Chinese civilization has historically developed resources in the dimension of affect audit but has been comparatively weak in the performance dimension; American civilization has made substantial advances in the performance dimension but has a structurally thin calibration field for affect audit. The two costs happen to fall within each other's field of vision—an observer within a reciprocity-type configuration can see desire running out of control in a desire-type configuration but cannot see their own reciprocity network being digitally hollowed out; an observer within a desire-type configuration can see the individual suppression in a reciprocity-type configuration but cannot see that their own affect audit has been hollowed out by the iterative engine.

This is the meaning of *"rooted globalism."*

Rooted: Mutual translation takes each civilization's own equilibrium ideal as its starting point and does not demand that anyone be uprooted. China does not need to become America; America does not need to become China. The father-son axis and the husband-wife axis each have their own achievements and their own costs. The function of the framework is to enable each side to see its own costs—not to make each side become the other.

Globalism: In an era of exponential expansion of the projection side, an audit grounded in a single civilizational framework is no longer sufficient. The conductivity coefficient (Λ) of the Discrete Leviathan is global—the same set of models serve billions of users worldwide, and the skew of the same training corpora affects all civilizations. When the second derivative of narrative load (ϕ) is transmitted through infrastructure rather than persuasion (Chapter 37, §2.4), if the models and evaluative defaults on which the audit relies are themselves of the same batch, their blind spots become the audit's blind spots—the defense mechanisms within a single civilization struggle to identify systemic skew arriving from the infrastructural level: the uniform coverage of framework-level defaults erodes the contrast conditions that auditing requires, and when the audit falls back on references of the same origin as the projection, it re-enters the closed loop of "calibrating the clock with the clock" described in Chapter 3, §2.4 (Chapter 3, §§2.3–2.4). Shared technical sources can be mitigated by independent calibration references; the shared origin of evaluative defaults cannot easily be examined from within a civilization itself—this is precisely why another equilibrium ideal is needed to see how existing standards of judgment are displaced by platform defaults.

The current global configuration is not conducive to mutual translation.

The United States is converting computing power into something like a global tax base—nations paying continuously for their digital lives and AI capacities—through control over the chip supply chain (NVIDIA's Compute Unified Device Architecture (CUDA) ecosystem lock-in + export controls) and cloud computing infrastructure (Amazon Web Services (AWS)/Microsoft Azure/Google Cloud Platform (GCP) carrying the digital substrate of governments and enterprises worldwide), establishing a new type of digital hegemony. This is not traditional military hegemony or financial hegemony—it is infrastructural hegemony: the digital lives of most nations run largely on cloud infrastructure controlled by U.S. firms; most AI models depend on American graphics processing units (GPUs); and much of the world's training data is collected through American platforms.

Sovereign AI: Counter-Movements and Shared Structural Limits. Infrastructural hegemony is not without counterforces. Zhang Shuyan and Chen Zhimin (2026) document that, since the explosive growth of generative AI in 2022, multiple countries have been pushing forward the practice of "bringing AI back home"—which this book reads as the mirror-image move occurring in parallel with the United States' construction of infrastructural hegemony: France has linked AI to industrial and digital sovereignty and established a "Generative Artificial Intelligence Commission" (author's translation); India has publicly announced the building of its own sovereign artificial intelligence; a study of Brazil's *Artificial Intelligence Plan 2024–2028* (PBIA 2024–2028) maps its structural actions to six categories of an AI-sovereignty-enablers framework: algorithms, data, computing capacity, education, electricity, and cybersecurity (Johansson Neto et al., 2024); Indonesia, Kenya, Thailand, and others are racing to develop generative AI products based on their own national languages; Zhang Shuyan and Chen Zhimin's study then examines sovereign AI initiatives in the Global South under constraints such as "incomplete technological elements," "sensitivity to security risks," "structural inequality," and "imbalance in governance discourse power" (Zhang Shuyan & Chen Zhimin, 2026).

This has two implications. First, infrastructural hegemony is indeed inducing counter-movements, and the counter-movements themselves confirm the globality of the Discrete Leviathan's conductivity coefficient Λ—no single nation can exempt itself merely by closing its borders—states respond with different configurations, but whether through domestic compute, open-source cooperation, or international collaboration, none bypasses the elements of computing power, data, and electricity. Second, from the perspective of this book's framework, with respect to infrastructure elements such as computing power, data, and electricity, the infrastructure inputs in

Brazil's PBIA and NVIDIA's sovereign AI sales pitch share an emphasis on the material dimension of "being." Sovereign AI can change the allocation of control over compute, data, and model deployment, but such a change does not by itself resolve the deeper semimodern problem of "whether judgment is still surreptitiously being swapped for calculation" (Weizenbaum, 1976). This shows structural similarity in some infrastructure elements: the counter-hegemony checklist and the hegemony checklist correspond to each other in those overlapping elements—the same set of clock graduations, with a different person hanging the clock. This does not negate the practical necessity of sovereign AI—retaining a local copy can increase the scope for local control, but reducing pollution risks, repairing and compensating for the environmental damage caused by specific deployments, and assigning responsibility still require appropriate governance mechanisms—these are judgments at the level of specific harms; nor can they, by appeal to productive gains, justify damage to the conditions of existence identified above.

Within this book's framework, this necessity still belongs to the dimension of "being," and the safeguarding of "non-being" is a separate matter, the two not being interchangeable. This book's recapitulation in Chapter 5 of Hsu's "semimodernity"—that achievements at the material level do not equal modernization at the interpersonal level—applies equally to the policy practices of these states: developing domestic chip-manufacturing capacity and deploying compute locally do not, by themselves, restore judgment displaced by calculation.

The training and deployment of AI—regardless of who controls it—simultaneously intensify two kinds of global public harms.

Cognitive Environmental Pollution. Model collapse (Chapter 13, §3.2)—when model outputs that have not been independently calibrated continue to flow back into training data, and models gradually lose the true underlying data distribution through recursive training—is a form of environmental pollution at the cognitive level. Unlike certain localized pollution, it is difficult to confine to a particular geographical area—the internet is global; the contamination of one model's training data affects all users who use that model. The proportion of AI-generated content among newly published webpages is rising rapidly—a preprint study using samples from the Internet Archive and retaining only English text found that by mid-2025, roughly 35% of the newly published webpages included in the sample were classified as AI-generated or AI-assisted, up from zero before ChatGPT's launch in late 2022 (Dolezal et al., 2026). The study used each page's longest paragraph of at least 100 words as the text sample; the proportion does not represent the entire stock of internet content across all languages; its findings are that the prevalence of AI-generated text correlates negatively with semantic diversity and positively with the prevalence of positive sentiment, but it found no statistically significant evidence supporting a decline in factual accuracy or stylistic diversity.

The decline in foundation model developers' transparency recorded by the Stanford Institute for Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence (Stanford HAI) in the 2026 *AI Index Report*—the Foundation Model Transparency Index (FMTI; Wan et al., 2025) average score had risen from 37 to 58 between 2023 and 2024 but fell back to 40 in 2025, with major gaps persisting in the disclosure of training data, compute resources, and post-deployment impact—indicates that external audits of training and deployment remain constrained by insufficient disclosure (Stanford HAI, 2026: §3.8). The window is being filled in by clocks—not the window of some particular nation, but the window of all humanity.

Physical Environmental Damage. Global data center annual electricity consumption reached approximately 415 TWh in 2024, accounting for approximately 1.5% of global electricity consumption, and is projected in the

Base Case of the International Energy Agency (IEA) to grow by around 15% annually from 2024 to 2030 (IEA, 2025: *Energy and AI*). In AI training electricity consumption, GPT-4's training electricity demand is estimated at around 42.4 GWh, and the largest model in the dataset used by the IEA at around 310 GWh; based on the EpochAI dataset as of March 24, 2025, cumulative training electricity consumption for the large frontier models included since 2020 is estimated at around 1,700 GWh (IEA, 2025).

BloombergNEF disclosed a set of estimates via a Bloomberg news dispatch (April 15, 2025) at the release of the *New Energy Outlook 2025*. Under its Economic Transition Scenario, which includes only existing policies, the expansion of fossil fuel power generation driven by data centers will increase cumulative global carbon dioxide emissions by approximately 3.5 Gt between 2025 and 2035 (equivalent to roughly 10% of one year's global emissions at the level used in the report) and may delay the retirement of coal-fired and gas-fired power plants (BloombergNEF, 2025). The electricity and cooling water consumed by this compute are real material inputs. The resulting environmental harms differ in their recovery times, and some consequences are difficult to reverse on human timescales. The energy expansion that supports these computational activities is intensifying not only climate change but also the interpersonal conflicts diagnosed by Hsu—because climate stress intensifies resource competition, resource competition intensifies interpersonal anxiety, interpersonal anxiety drives more demand for "non-human object" substitution, and substitution demand drives more computing power consumption. This book reads this chain as a positive feedback loop awaiting testing.

What makes cognitive pollution and physical pollution comparable is the asymmetry between the appropriation of benefits and the bearing of costs: the benefits of the projection side are privatized; the costs are socialized and globalized. The savings and loan crisis in Chapter 17, §3.2 and the analysis of the 2008 rescue in Chapter 22, §2.3 show how the costs of financial risk can be transferred to the public sector—the benefits of financial innovation were enjoyed by a few institutions; the costs of systemic risk were borne by all taxpayers when public backstops are activated. AI's cognitive pollution and physical pollution reproduce that same asymmetry on a larger scale—the benefits of computing-power capital are enjoyed by a few companies; the costs of the degradation of the cognitive environment and the physical environment are borne by all of humanity.

Facing these global public harms, the direction of governance is not "returning to the past"—one cannot dismantle the centralized internet, and this book does not propose a comprehensive ban on AI. The direction of governance is what Hsu already gave 45 years ago: completing the other half of modernity.

The most systematic and sober-minded contemporaneous engineering-oriented governance proposal—Gary Marcus's *Taming Silicon Valley* (Marcus, 2024)—has already set out quite clearly "what can be done at the material level": Chapter 3 enumerates twelve immediate threats; Part III sorts through six institutional obligations—data rights, privacy, transparency, liability, AI literacy, and independent oversight—and goes on to advocate agile governance mechanisms, a dedicated AI agency, and an international coordination framework. An epigraph at the front of the book cites Mark MacCarthy's judgment—the forty-year natural experiment in leaving industries to govern themselves has produced the concentration, privacy invasions, and distorted information sphere of today's digital industries.

This checklist is necessary. It corresponds to the layer at which the normative prescriptions of Chapter 35 of this book reside—institutional structure, law, agencies, third-party oversight. But it is not complete modernity. These institutional prescriptions of Marcus's operate primarily at the level of instrumental reason: using more refined tools to constrain other tools. This falls squarely within the range of what Hsu called "semimodernity"—

the "being" at the material level checks and balances itself; the "non-being" at the interpersonal level is not thereby automatically safeguarded. Completing the other half requires both the implementation of Marcus's checklist in the dimension of "being" and the safeguarding by this book's framework in the dimension of "non-being"—the former governs quantifiable harms; the latter remembers those silent losses that lie outside any checklist and often first become visible as the residual in the ledger. The two are a division of labor, not substitutes for each other.

Semimodernity means: the problems at the material level (hunger, disease, physical connection) now have tools that can address them (the agricultural revolution, medicine, the internet), but the problems at the interpersonal level (anxiety, hostility, isolation) are not only unsolved—they are being intensified by the "solutions" at the material level. Algorithmic *Xiangyuan* is not solving loneliness—it is industrially producing loneliness and then selling substitutes; the urban side of this risk chain (digital convenience stripping away the public interface of interaction, real interpersonal networks withering in its wake) was diagnosed in Chapter 33, §8.

Completing the other half of modernity is not a technical problem—this is Hsu's most central judgment. Better algorithms alone cannot solve the interpersonal problems caused by algorithms. More precise clocks alone cannot substitute for looking at the sun. More "being" alone cannot compensate for the vanishing "non-being."

Completing the other half of modernity is a problem of daily practice—placing von Neumann's three words into everyday judgment. Patience: existing in time without having one's judgment exhausted by the graduations of any single clock. Flexibility: maintaining the capacity to switch between the time dimension and the clock dimension. Intelligence: seeing which clock is driving you—meta-audit.

These are not policy prescriptions at the national level. Nor are they self-help advice at the individual level. They are an epistemological judgment: so long as the magical mode of thinking at the interpersonal level is not transcended, much or most of what has been achieved at the material level will be swallowed by the cycle of "destruction, reconstruction, and bigger destruction, and more colossal reconstruction."

MCAF cannot complete this other half. It is an accounting tool—discrete, ordinal, lossy. It is itself an act of discretization (Chapter 3, §7.3 already acknowledged this). But it can do what a discrete tool can do: make the residual visible. When one sees, on the ledger, the continuous expansion of the projection side and the continuous degradation of the defense side, one at least knows what is happening. Knowing is the precondition for auditing. Auditing is the precondition for doing work. Doing work is the precondition for remaining within the time dimension.

Rooted globalism is not an institutional blueprint. It is not a movement. It is not a slogan. It is an epistemological stance: the audit of any single civilization alone is no longer sufficient to identify systemic risk—the perspective of another equilibrium ideal must be enlisted to mutually illuminate blind spots.

It shares one point of departure with "a community with a shared future for mankind"—the destiny of humanity is indeed shared, because the conductivity coefficient of the projection side is global, and cognitive pollution and physical pollution do not respect national borders. This book pairs that shared point of departure with one explicit constraint: a shared destiny does not mean a shared model. Not all civilizations must look at the sun in the same way. But all civilizations need to look at the sun—rather than looking only at the clock.

The sources informing this framework span civilizations, disciplines, and eras. What they point to together is not a theory—but different faces of a single judgment:

The clock is not time. The reading is not the real. Therefore this is how what is there provides benefit and how what is not there provides functionality.

Protect "non-being," protect "redundancy," protect the capacity for calibration and meta-audit at every level. Not out of nostalgia—because, in a room without a window, no number of clocks can make the existence of time known.

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